NCCP 00890 · VERSION 2A

Your treatment, explained

Metastatic colorectal cancer after standard therapies and trifluridine/tipiracil or regorafenib · NCCP 00890 v2a · Document revised 5 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

Fruquintinib (Fruzaqla) monotherapy

28-day cycle

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

ACT ON SYMPTOMS, NOT THE CALENDAR

When to get help

Emergency: call 112 / 999

Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain: call emergency services. Do not wait for an online answer.

Contact your oncology service immediately

Temperature 37.5°C or higher, 36°C or lower, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell — even with a normal temperature. Get urgent help for severe or persistent tummy pain, black or bloody stools, coughing or vomiting blood, new severe headache, confusion, seizure, visual change, chest pain, sudden breathlessness or very little urine. Report fever, sudden illness, painful hands/feet and new bleeding promptly.

Follow the urgent contact instructions from your treating hospital. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Outside clinic hours, use your instructed out-of-hours pathway or the emergency department.

This page does not diagnose symptoms or decide whether it is safe to stay at home. You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

Open your CUH contact / treatment card

Sources: smpc

Choose a topic to read

YOUR COMPLETE REFERENCE

Read what you need, when you need it.

Start with the overview, explore the cycle, or go straight to a question. Urgent advice is always available.

- How each drug works
- Capsules and rest days
- Your 28-day timeline
- Baseline and cycle-specific checks
- Whole treatment, scans and checks
- Tablets, visits and practical planning
- Why this treatment may be offered
- How fruquintinib works
- Your capsule and rest-day plan
- Checks and follow-up
- Skin, mouth, eating and energy
- Symptoms needing urgent help
- Other medicines, wounds and procedures
- Pregnancy precautions and safe storage
- Supportive medicines
- Understanding the evidence
- Questions to ask

Sources

UNDERSTAND YOUR TREATMENT

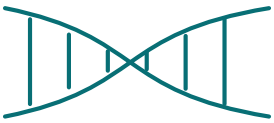
Your targeted medicine

Fruquintinib is a targeted capsule treatment to help control bowel cancer that has spread after previous treatments. The team checks which treatments you have received, whether they remain suitable, and your priorities.

TARGETED THERAPY CAPSULE

Fruquintinib

Fruzaqla



Blocks VEGF receptor signals

Fruquintinib blocks VEGF receptor signals that help tumours form blood vessels. Reducing these signals can slow cancer growth. Blood vessels in healthy tissues are also affected, which helps explain blood-pressure, bleeding, protein-in-urine and wound-healing risks.

VEGF signals → Receptors blocked → Blood-vessel growth reduced

What to watch for

Report painful hands/feet, bowel changes, bleeding or neurological symptoms; attend blood-pressure, urine and blood checks even if well.

Sources: smpc

The drawings are simplified explanations of drug action, not anatomical pictures or a prediction of response.

Explore your existing anatomy and side-effect map

REGIMEN-SPECIFIC SIDE EFFECTS

Your anatomical side-effect map

A picture of side effects

Match each symptom box to its numbered body location. Tell your team about new symptoms.

1 Head / thyroid / energy

Fruquintinib

Fatigue and thyroid changes can affect daily life. Severe headache, confusion, seizure or visual change needs emergency help.

3 Heart / blood pressure

Fruquintinib

Blood pressure may rise without symptoms. Keep scheduled checks. Chest pain, collapse or severe breathlessness needs emergency care.

5 Liver

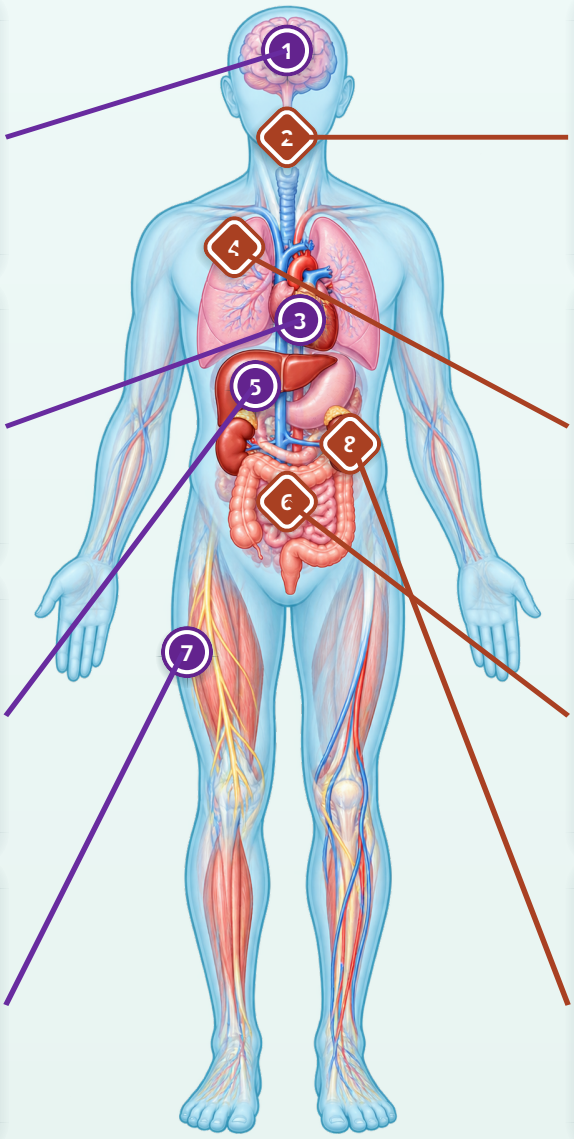
Fruquintinib

Liver tests can change before symptoms occur. Report yellow eyes or skin, dark urine or persistent abdominal pain.

7 Hands / feet / skin

Fruquintinib

Pain, redness, swelling or blisters can affect walking or using your hands. Report early and follow the skin-care plan.



2 Mouth / appetite

Fruquintinib

Mouth soreness, voice change and poor appetite can affect eating. Report difficulty drinking or weight loss.

4 Blood / bleeding

Fruquintinib

New bleeding, easy bruising, fever or sudden illness needs prompt advice. Heavy bleeding needs emergency help.

6 Bowel / abdomen

Fruquintinib

Diarrhoea can cause dehydration. Severe persistent pain, black stools or blood in stools needs urgent help.

8 Kidneys / urine

Fruquintinib

Protein in urine may have no early symptoms. Attend urine checks and report swelling or much less urine.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

THE BIGGER TREATMENT PLAN

Capsules and rest days

28-DAY CYCLE

21 capsule days, then seven rest days

D1–21 D22–28

Take the prescribed fruquintinib dose once daily on Days 1–21, then take no fruquintinib on Days 22–28. Take it at about the same time each day, with or without food. Repeat only when your team authorises the next cycle.

No fixed final cycle. Continue only while benefit and tolerability justify treatment.

Sources: nccp

BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

Tests before, during and after treatment

NCCP specifies regular blood/urine/thyroid tests but no universal frequency for each. Ask your team to write the dates. Scans and tumour markers are individualised.

Check	Before starting	First month	Later cycles	A hold or procedure	After treatment
Blood pressure	Control existing hypertension	Weekly blood-pressure checks	Monthly and as clinically indicated	Review control before restarting	Follow persistent hypertension as agreed
Blood count, kidneys, liver and thyroid	Baseline tests	Regular tests on the team plan	Continue regular tests	Repeat abnormal tests as directed	Follow unresolved effects
Urine protein	Baseline urine dipstick	Regular urine checks	Extra measurement if protein is detected	Review kidney/urine findings before restarting	Individual follow-up if abnormal
INR if taking warfarin	Review anticoagulation	Weekly INR until a stable dose	Then before each cycle	Additional checks when medicines or health change	Anticoagulation-team plan
Scans and clinical review	Confirm previous treatments and goals	Review symptoms, skin, nutrition and adherence	Disease assessment as directed by consultant	Team authorises any restart	Agree subsequent care and contacts

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. NCCP 00890 v2a official fruquintinib regimen

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Fruquintinib (Fruzaqla) monotherapy: treatment and checks

Metastatic colorectal cancer after standard therapies and trifluridine/tipiracil or regorafenib

Take the prescribed fruquintinib dose once daily on Days 1–21, then take no fruquintinib on Days 22–28. Take it at about the same time each day, with or without food. Repeat only when your team authorises the next cycle.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

On a small screen, swipe the map sideways. The checks below give the same timing in words.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	First month	Later cycles	A hold or procedure	After treatment
Blood pressure NCCP 00890	Control existing hypertension	Weekly blood-pressure checks	Monthly and as clinically indicated	Review control before restarting	Follow persistent hypertension as agreed
Blood count, kidneys, liver and thyroid NCCP 00890	Baseline tests	Regular tests on the team plan	Continue regular tests	Repeat abnormal tests as directed	Follow unresolved effects
Urine protein NCCP 00890	Baseline urine dipstick	Regular urine checks	Extra measurement if protein is detected	Review kidney/urine findings before restarting	Individual follow-up if abnormal
INR if taking warfarin NCCP 00890	Review anticoagulation	Weekly INR until a stable dose	Then before each cycle	Additional checks when medicines or health change	Anticoagulation-team plan
Scans and clinical review NCCP 00890	Confirm previous treatments and goals	Review symptoms, skin, nutrition and adherence	Disease assessment as directed by consultant	Team authorises any restart	Agree subsequent care and contacts

What each check is for

1

21 capsule days, then seven rest days

28-day cycle

Fruquintinib is a targeted capsule treatment to help control bowel cancer that has spread after previous treatments. The team checks which treatments you have received, whether they remain suitable, and your priorities.

Ask / act: Confirm the current phase, prescription, tests and support medicines.

Sources: NCCP 00890

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-11-05 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.35

YOUR CYCLE, DAY BY DAY

Your 28-day cycle.

Select a day to explore what to watch for. These are possible patterns, not a promise about when symptoms start or stop.

> The full information is available below. Interactive day, phase and date controls require JavaScript; use “Read the whole cycle as text” for the complete timeline.

Your date stays on this page only. It is not saved or added to a QR code.

Medicines on Day 1: Fruquintinib

On a small screen, swipe the chart sideways. Each day is a keyboard-accessible button.

Days 1–28 of this cycle

Treatment or check	Days in this cycle	What happens
Fruquintinib capsules	Days 1–21	Once daily, with or without food
Capsule-free week	Days 22–28	No fruquintinib; review recovery and next prescription
Symptoms, BP and tests	Days 1–28	Report symptoms on treatment days and rest days

The calendar shows capsule days and rest days. Symptoms are not confined to a particular week.

DAY 1

Start with a clear calendar

Take the prescribed daily dose with or without food. Keep blood-pressure appointments and check hands and feet.

Your next step: Confirm the first tests, urine checks and skin-care instructions.

The next cycle starts 28 days after this one, if your team confirms it.

> Use your oncology unit's urgent contact plan throughout the cycle, including tablet-free days. Symptoms can need attention before the next blood test or appointment.

Read the whole cycle as text

Day 1–7: Start with a clear calendar

Take the prescribed daily dose with or without food. Keep blood-pressure appointments and check hands and feet. Confirm the first tests, urine checks and skin-care instructions.

Day 8–21: Continue capsules and monitoring

Symptoms may develop over time. Report painful hands/feet, bowel changes, poor appetite, bleeding or fatigue. Blood pressure is checked weekly during the first month. Do not wait until the rest week to report problems.

Day 22–28: Capsule-free week

Take no fruquintinib. Symptoms may persist. The team may delay the next cycle or prescribe a lower dose. Complete planned checks and confirm the next dose and start date.

Sources: nccp

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.



STEP 1

Prescription and calendar

Take the prescribed fruquintinib dose once daily on Days 1–21, then take no fruquintinib on Days 22–28. Take it at about the same time each day, with or without food. Repeat only when your team authorises the next cycle.



STEP 2

Taking capsules

The usual starting dose is 5 mg once daily, but follow your own label. Swallow capsules whole with water, with or without food; do not chew, dissolve or open them. Tell the team before starting if swallowing capsules is difficult.



STEP 3

Missed or vomited dose

If a dose is less than 12 hours late, take it and then follow the usual schedule. If more than 12 hours late, skip it and take the next dose at the normal time. At exactly 12 hours, or if unsure, ask your pharmacist or team. Do not take a replacement capsule after vomiting; take the next dose at the usual time.



STEP 4

Tests and visits

Baseline and regular blood count, kidney/ liver profile, thyroid function and urine protein. Blood pressure must be controlled before starting, then checked weekly for the first month and monthly thereafter, or more often if needed. For warfarin, INR weekly until stable, then before each cycle. Scans and markers follow the consultant plan.



STEP 5

Storage

Keep the original bottle tightly closed to protect from moisture and out of children's sight and reach. No special temperature conditions are required. Follow the expiry date and ask the pharmacist how to return unused capsules; do not put them into household waste or wastewater.



STEP 6

Treatment changes

Your team must confirm dose changes and restarts. Bring the capsule pack, current calendar and medicine list to review.

Open practical treatment guide · Printable practical guide

Sources: NCCP 00890 v2a official fruquintinib regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.

MAKE THE PLAN PRACTICAL

Support around the medicines

1 Skin care

Use the unit’s skin-care plan and report redness, pain, swelling or blisters early. The team may prescribe creams or change treatment. Do not wait until walking or everyday hand use is difficult.

2 Sickness and bowels

This oral medicine has minimal-to-low emetogenic potential. Routine premedication is not usually needed; agree any anti-sickness and diarrhoea medicines with the team. Persistent vomiting, diarrhoea, poor intake or reduced urine needs prompt advice.

3 Blood pressure and medication review

Take prescribed blood-pressure medicines and keep monitoring visits. Tell the team about anticoagulants and every prescription, over-the-counter and herbal medicine.

4 Pregnancy and breastfeeding

Use highly effective contraception during treatment and for at least two weeks after the last dose if you could become pregnant. Do not breastfeed during treatment or for at least two weeks afterwards.

Sources: nccp · smpc

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 01

Why this treatment may be offered

Confirm the treatment history and personal goals.

Previously treated bowel cancer

Fruquintinib is a targeted capsule treatment to help control bowel cancer that has spread after previous treatments. The team checks which treatments you have received, whether they remain suitable, and your priorities. The team confirms the full treatment history, including chemotherapy, anti-VEGF and anti-EGFR treatment where applicable, and progression or intolerance on trifluridine/tipiracil or regorafenib.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Evidence and uncertainty

Median overall survival was 7.4 months with fruquintinib and 4.8 months with placebo. These group medians are not a prediction of one person's lifespan or a guaranteed extra 2.6 months. The team should discuss the balance of benefit and side effects for you.

Sources: fresco2

Treatment duration

There is no fixed total number of cycles. Continue while benefit and tolerability justify it; the team reviews symptoms, scans, tests and your preferences.

Sources: nccp · smpc

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 02

How fruquintinib works

It affects signals involved in blood-vessel growth.

VEGF receptor signals

Fruquintinib blocks VEGF receptor signals that help tumours form blood vessels. Reducing these signals can slow cancer growth. Blood vessels in healthy tissues are also affected, which helps explain blood-pressure, bleeding, protein-in-urine and wound-healing risks.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Safety checks

Blood-pressure and urine-protein changes can develop without symptoms. Tests and early symptom reporting help the team decide whether treatment can safely continue.

Sources: nccp · smpc

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 03

Your capsule and rest-day plan

Use your own prescription and calendar.

Days 1–21 and Days 22–28

Take the prescribed fruquintinib dose once daily on Days 1–21, then take no fruquintinib on Days 22–28. Take it at about the same time each day, with or without food. Repeat only when your team authorises the next cycle.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Swallow whole, with or without food

The usual starting dose is 5 mg once daily, but follow your own label. Swallow capsules whole with water, with or without food; do not chew, dissolve or open them. Tell the team before starting if swallowing capsules is difficult.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Missed or vomited dose

If a dose is less than 12 hours late, take it and then follow the usual schedule. If more than 12 hours late, skip it and take the next dose at the normal time. At exactly 12 hours, or if unsure, ask your pharmacist or team. Do not take a replacement capsule after vomiting; take the next dose at the usual time.

Sources: nccp · smpc

If too much is taken

Contact your doctor immediately if you take more than prescribed. You may need medical attention; take the pack and treatment calendar with you.

Sources: nccp · smpc

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 04

Checks and follow-up

Feeling well does not replace testing.

Before and during treatment

Baseline and regular blood count, kidney/liver profile, thyroid function and urine protein. Blood pressure must be controlled before starting, then checked weekly for the first month and monthly thereafter, or more often if needed. For warfarin, INR weekly until stable, then before each cycle. Scans and markers follow the consultant plan.

Sources: nccp · smpc

If a test is abnormal

The team may arrange extra blood or urine tests, treat hypertension, pause capsules, reduce the dose or stop treatment. Do not change the dose yourself.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Scans and tumour markers

The consultant decides the imaging and marker schedule for your situation. This regimen does not mandate a fixed CT or CEA interval.

Sources: nccp · smpc

After a pause or stopping

Ask who follows persistent symptoms and abnormal tests, and when the next review is due. Do not restart without clear instructions.

Sources: nccp · smpc

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 05

Skin, mouth, eating and energy

Early support can help preserve daily activities.

Hands and feet

Use the unit’s skin-care plan and report redness, pain, swelling or blisters early. The team may prescribe creams or change treatment. Do not wait until walking or everyday hand use is difficult.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Bowels, fluids and sickness

This oral medicine has minimal-to-low emetogenic potential. Routine premedication is not usually needed; agree any anti-sickness and diarrhoea medicines with the team. Persistent vomiting, diarrhoea, poor intake or reduced urine needs prompt advice.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Mouth and appetite

Report mouth soreness, voice changes, poor appetite or weight loss. Ask for mouth care and nutritional support. Drink as advised for your health.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Fatigue and thyroid

New marked fatigue, feeling unusually cold, weight or skin changes may need thyroid assessment. Balance activity with rest and report symptoms affecting usual activities.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Driving

Do not drive or use machinery if tiredness or other symptoms affect concentration or reactions.

Sources: smpc

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 06

Symptoms needing urgent help

A rare effect may still need immediate care.

Bleeding and bowel problems

Seek urgent help for black or bloody stools, blood in urine, coughing/vomiting blood, severe or persistent abdominal pain. Heavy bleeding or collapse needs emergency care.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Neurological, heart or vascular symptoms

Severe headache with confusion, seizure or visual changes, chest pain, severe breathlessness, sudden weakness or sudden severe chest/back/abdominal pain requires emergency help.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Kidneys, skin and infection

Report much less urine or swelling, painful hands/feet, fever, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell. Symptoms may need assessment even during the capsule-free week.

Sources: nccp · smpc

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 07

Other medicines, wounds and procedures

Tell every treating team you take fruquintinib.

Medication review

Tell the pharmacist about anticoagulants, antibiotics, infection treatments, seizure medicines, herbal remedies and supplements. Rifampicin and other strong enzyme inducers can affect fruquintinib exposure. Ask before starting or stopping anything.

Sources: smpc

Wound healing and surgery

Report unhealed wounds and planned surgery. Product information recommends withholding fruquintinib for at least two weeks before surgery and not restarting for at least two weeks afterwards and until adequate wound healing. Your oncology and surgical teams must agree the exact plan; do not stop or restart it yourself.

Sources: smpc

Allergies

Tell the pharmacist about medicine or colouring-agent allergies. Capsule colours differ by strength and contain colouring agents that can cause allergic reactions.

Sources: smpc

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 08

Pregnancy precautions and safe storage

Keep the medicine in its labelled packaging.

Pregnancy and feeding

Use highly effective contraception during treatment and for at least two weeks after the last dose if you could become pregnant. Do not breastfeed during treatment or for at least two weeks afterwards.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Storage

Keep the original bottle tightly closed to protect from moisture and out of children's sight and reach. No special temperature conditions are required. Follow the expiry date and ask the pharmacist how to return unused capsules; do not put them into household waste or wastewater.

Sources: smpc

Your treatment record

Carry the wallet card and current medicine list. Record the prescribed dose, any holds, symptoms, BP and upcoming tests. Replace all example telephone numbers with your real oncology contacts before using the card.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Evidence in previously treated colorectal cancer

FRESCO-2 compared fruquintinib plus best supportive care with placebo plus best supportive care after previous metastatic colorectal treatments.

Median overall survival was 7.4 months with fruquintinib and 4.8 months with placebo. These group medians are not a prediction of one person's lifespan or a guaranteed extra 2.6 months. The team should discuss the balance of benefit and side effects for you.

Sources: fresco2 · smpc

PREPARE FOR THE CONVERSATION

Questions worth asking

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Try explaining the plan back: Can you show the 21 tablet days and seven rest days, explain the meal and missed-dose instructions, identify the early liver and blood-pressure checks, and say whom you will call if unwell?

SOURCE TRANSPARENCY

Where this information comes from

Regimen schedule: NCCP 00890 v2a. Medicine explanations and safety information: sources below. The timeline is an educational illustration, not a measured risk curve or an individual prediction.

- NCCP 00890 v2a official fruquintinib regimen
- EMA Fruzaqla product information and patient leaflet
- FRESCO-2 randomised phase III trial
- HSE treatment safety and urgent advice

SACTCheck · Developed by Dr Paul O'Brien · Sources checked 2026-11-05.
This information supports your treatment discussion. Your oncology team confirms your personal treatment and urgent-care plan.

Written source addresses

https://healthservice.hse.ie/documents/6648/Fruquintinib_890.pdf

https://www.ema.europa.eu/en/documents/product-information/fruzaqla-epar-product-information_en.pdf

https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/37331369/

https://www2.hse.ie/conditions/chemotherapy/side-effects/